

Senses is a concept floated last year by Ericsson as part of its vision for 2030. It proposes the idea of a full sensory immersion in cyberspace, made possible by the low latency and high bandwidth of 5G.

The new-age collectibles

Movies and cricket are two undying passions in India. Digital collectibles, that is NFTs, are likely to do well in both these fields.

A couple of months back, Singapore based Vistas Media Capital partnered with *Rocketry - The Nambi Effect* to introduce NFTs themed around the movie plot and scientific research on their metaverse space called the VistaVerse. It was a runaway success, with more than 10,000 NFTs being claimed.

Zee Entertainment Enterprises, the well-known media house, opened its Tech & Innovation centre in Bengaluru a couple of months ago. Among other things, the centre will focus on Zee's metaverse, the Zeeverse, which will offer numerous interesting NFTs from the movies, music, and shows that the company holds the license to. According to the company, viewers will also be able to meet their favourite stars through the Zeeverse.

Earlier this year, T-Series announced a partnership with Hefty Entertainment, a division of Hungama Digital Media, to drop NFTs that leverage its mega content library.

In October, cricketer Virat Kohli tweeted that he was super pumped to enter the metaverse exclusively with FanCraze. This means, his fans can now buy digital collectibles, such as the digital version of a signed bat or poster, or a valuable cricketing moment, directly licensed from Kohli, and display them on their social media handles, trade them, and use them in various games.

Kohli joins a long list of Indian cricketers, including Rohit Sharma,



Users can tour a virtual facsimile of the INTERPOL General Secretariat headquarters in Lyon, France without any geographical or physical boundaries (Courtesy: INTERPOL)

Hardik Pandya, Suryakumar Yadav, Ravindra Jadeja, Shikhar Dhawan, Ravichandran Ashwin, Yuzvendra Chahal, and Shreyas Iyer, who have also partnered with FanCraze to drop digital collectibles and build a direct connect with their fans. "We view marquee athletes as artists who create their art on the field of play," said FanCraze CEO Anshum Bhambri, in a media report.

It does not stop with buying NFTs but leads to more ways of engagement. For example, fans may be able to get on a Zoom call with a player whose collectibles they own, go to a nets session with them, interview them, or have access to signed merchandise.

A new crime scene for INTERPOL

At the 90th INTERPOL General Assembly held in New Delhi in October, the global police organisation unveiled its new metaverse, designed specifically for law enforcement. Registered users can tour a virtual replica of INTERPOL's headquarters, interact with other officers via their avatars, and even take immersive training courses. During the demo, experts delivered a training on travel document verification and passenger screening using INTERPOL capabilities in a metaverse classroom. Students were then teleported to an

airport where they were able to practically try out these skills at a virtual border point.

Law enforcers from around the world will benefit greatly from this metaverse in terms of remote work, networking, collaboration,

collecting, and preserving evidence from crime scenes, and training in specific skills like forensic investigation. However, skilling up is not the only motive behind launching the metaverse. INTERPOL also wants law enforcers to better understand metaverse dynamics so they can prevent or address crimes therein.

The INTERPOL also announced the creation of an expert group on the metaverse, "to represent the concerns of law enforcement on the global stage—ensuring this new virtual world is secure by design."

According to a Gartner report, by 2026, one in every four people will spend at least an hour a day in the metaverse to work, study, shop, and socialise. On the other hand, the newly released INTERPOL Global Crime Trend report shows that crime has increasingly moved online. The World Economic Forum has also warned of social engineering scams, violent extremism, and misinformation on the metaverse.

As the metaverse grows, we are likely to see crimes against children, data theft, money laundering, financial fraud, counterfeiting, ransomware, phishing, and sexual assault and harassment. These will present significant challenges for law enforcement. Hence, this pre-emptive